

The Dragon Battle

Inspired by a Welsh legend.

“Build me a fortress!” Ordered the warlord king. “Build it high on that hill. Build it with turrets and moats. This beautiful green land shall be ours, and we will fly our flag with pride.”

The king’s people followed his orders and got to work. They used pulleys and trolleys to heave huge rocks into place, and by the end of the first day the fortress’ foundations were laid. In thanks, the king put on a feast for his people. They ate and drank and talked under the moon.

By midnight, the workers fell asleep. In their dreams they saw the walls and turrets they would build the next day, high up on that hill above Wales.



Not knowing what else to do, they went back to work again. By nightfall of the second night, they had relaid the foundations and built four towers.

That night, watched only by the moon and stars, the ground beneath the new foundations, and the four mighty towers began to rumble again. The ground shook and shook, until all that was left was more rubble.

“Who has cursed this land?” The king dropped to his knees in despair at the piles of rock in front of him.

Aware that his people stood behind him, he pulled himself up. “We will not let this defeat us,” he said rising to his feet, “we must work even harder!”

Confused and frustrated, the people set to work again. They worked so hard that by nightfall, they had relaid the foundations, rebuilt all four towers, and even dug a moat.

But again, during the night the ground shook and the towers crumbled.

All the people could do was stand behind their king and stare. Until finally a young boy stepped forward and addressed the king.

But as they slept, the ground beneath the new foundations began to rumble, and the foundations started to shake.

Soon, all that was left was a pile of rubble scattered on the hill.

The people woke and gathered around the piles of stones at the bottom of the hill, shaking their heads in confusion.